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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, February 27, 2025

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E_RqP8rxbzs
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:21:43] Thank you to Reynolds Community College, obviously, for having us here today hosting our two-day meeting series here at Haram Road Campus, a little closer to him for me, so nice. As customary for our board, we will begin our meeting with a moment of silence, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance, so join me in a moment of silence, please.

[00:22:08] I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, visible, tea and justice for all.

[00:22:38] We had extensive comments yesterday during our work session, so I would like to ensure that we are efficient today in our business meeting.

[00:22:54] And so for that purpose, we will move on into our approval of our agenda. Is there a motion to approve the agenda as presented? So moved. Dr. Northern, Ms. Kilgore.

[00:23:11] Aye. Ms. McPherson. Aye. Ms. Holton. And Chair votes aye. Okay, staff has provided the minutes to the members of the board in draft form before the meeting. Is there a motion to approve the minutes as presented to the board?

[00:23:31] Mr. Northern, Ms. Kilgore, Ms. McPherson, Ms. Holton, and Chair votes aye. So this morning we have a special student performance, and as always, the board appreciates the ability to have such wonderful performing arts programs from across the Commonwealth.

[00:23:54] Having students perform at our meeting, it's always the highlight of our day. And Ms. Kilgore is here to do our introduction for today's performance. Good morning. The Thomas Dale Performing Arts Department will present selections from their spring musical, Into the Woods.

[00:24:13] The production is a collaboration between the theater, music, dance, and visual arts departments at Thomas Dale High School, the Specialty Center for the Arts in Chesterfield County. Our amazing cast and crew will perform the full show March 21st through 23rd.

[00:24:31] Joining us today is Dr. John Murray, Superintendent of Chesterfield County School Division, Dr. Robin Yeo, Chesterfield County Curriculum Specialist for the Performing Arts, Catherine Mazzola, Assistant Principal, Taylor Bernard, Director, and Music Director, Stephen Rudland and Kristen Batson.

[00:24:50] Our students are delighted to share No One is Alone and the finale from Into the Woods.

[00:24:55] please join me in welcoming this group don't say that of course you were meant to have children

[00:26:22] just call the look tell him the story of how it all happened to be father and mother you'll know

[00:26:37] what to do sometimes people leave you do not let it grieve you you are not alone so long

[00:27:07] to the right now, let him see the glow, this will be all right now, tell him what year you

[00:28:39] man wishes our children, careful with how they tell, ships come true, that's free, not just some children, sometimes the spell may last, what you can see, what you can see,

[00:29:18] Though it's fearful, though it's deep, though certainly you may lose, you can't just act, you have to be fearful.

[00:29:40] It's fearful, though it's deep, though it's deep, though certainly you may lose, you can't just act, you have to be fearful. Though it's deep, though it's deep, though it's deep, though certainly you may lose, you can't just act, you have to be fearful. To the woods, but not too fast, To what you wish you could have passed.

[00:29:57] To the woods, but not too fast, To the woods, but not too strange. To the woods, but not too strange, To the woods, but not too strange. To the woods, but not too strange, To the woods, it's time, it's time, it's time

today or viewing this stream now or in the future. When you begin, please provide your name, role, or affiliation, and where you live in Virginia. All remarks must be directed to the chair, not at any other individual. Speakers

[00:38:03] will have three minutes. The screen right here will show your three minutes, and the timer on the screen will be green when the three minutes is posted. At one minute, the screen will turn yellow, and the screen will turn red when time is up. At that point, please promptly close your comments. Speakers may provide copies of their comments to Mr. Joe Crook, who is sitting in the front here, the department's regulatory and board coordinator. All written comments received during public comment will be collected and provided to the board as soon as possible. You may also email

[00:38:38] a copy of your remarks to the board at boe.doe.virginia.gov. And this morning we will begin with Scott Braebrand followed by Matt Delaney. Good morning, President Creasy, Dr. Koons and members of the State Board of Education. My name is Scott Braebrand and I'm Executive Director for VAS. We appreciate all the work the State Board and the VDOE staff have done over the past few months since you all have last met. Today we are pleased to see the work that has been done around

[00:39:17] expanding the approved textbooks and instructional materials for math, providing the appropriate and general assembly-aligned update to the calculation for SLIFE students for graduation rates, sharing key information around the upcoming standard setting process. We appreciate those efforts. Please know that we look forward around standard setting to your continued updates. We learned a lot yesterday in your meeting and we look forward to continuing to learn more as we prepare for the 25-26 school year for our superintendents and students and staff. We also appreciate the updated draft around work-based learning experiences. Generally we

[00:39:55] appreciate the additional clarity of high-quality work-based learning experiences, that checklist that's now been provided, as well as the expanded definitions for the four designated work-based learning areas. Specifically, our positive feedback includes the following: the addition of VAP for internships and the inclusion of Project SEARCH, WWRC, and other work-based learning experience programs for special education kids; the expansion of school-based enterprise to include entrepreneurship or student businesses.

[00:40:27] The clarification that an authentic worksite can include virtual and simulated work and the reduction of the minimum required hours to 90 hours. We appreciate all of that and we appreciate also the phased-in approach and we look forward to partnering with Dr. Coons and her staff to implement work-based learning experiences next year please know please know that we need a robust robust set of training materials and supports to support this high quality work-based learning experiences so that they can occur in every single school

[00:41:06] division your consideration of a statewide tracking system to help monitor these experiences is also appreciated we've also talked about having a work based coordinator in every school system and not every school district currently has the resources to do that. But we're excited about the work is done, and we look forward to partnering with you on these and other efforts as we prepare for the next school year. Thank you very much. Matt Delaney, followed by Lily Balance. Good morning, President Creasy, members of the Board of Education, and Dr. Coons. My name is Matthew Delaney, and I serve as the Chief Schools

[00:41:46] Officer for Virginia Beach City Public Schools. I'm here today to talk about seat time flexibility. As was shared in yesterday's meeting by Dr. Coons and Dr. Armstrong, we are really energized by the

opportunity to implement seat-time flexibility models in Virginia Beach City Public Schools.

[00:42:03] I'd like to thank Dr. Coons and Dr. Armstrong for coming down to Virginia Beach to visit three of our high schools. Our principals, teachers, and students were so appreciative of your comments, especially our students, as Dr. Coons reinforced to the group about the unique educational experience they were receiving in the blended model.

[00:42:20] And our principals appreciated the opportunity to share some barriers that they'd like to be addressed moving forward. Our journey in Virginia Beach started in 2019 as all of our high schools and centers began working on redesigning the high school experience.

[00:42:35] What we called the four pillars of high school redesign. Specific components were given to all schools while also providing building leaders the flexibility to generate innovative ideas that best suited their student populations and the talents of their staff. All of our high schools created school-specific high school redesign concept maps that outline what high school redesign would look like at their school, culminating with graduates having the skills ensuring they are ready to be enrolled, enlisted, or be employed.

[00:43:06] Yesterday, Dr. Coons referenced her visit to Bayside High School as one example in the BioFit classroom. When students complete this course, they will receive two academic credits and a CPR certification. They will have the opportunity to pass the life-saving exam, lifeguarding exam, giving them an opportunity to work as certified lifeguards.

[00:43:27] And several of them will have the opportunity to become certified and personal trainer. Our students are engaging in innovative learning experiences with tailored support, all while maintaining mastery expectations within the standards of learning. Now the challenge for us is to provide these experiences for all students.

[00:43:45] A significant start is in the providing of seat time. Seat time requirements and work-based learning requirements have been a significant barrier for school divisions to find innovative ways to redesign a learning experience for students. We greatly appreciate the Board of Education's willingness to look at innovative opportunities and that you are providing school divisions with the permission to create alternative models to instructional time. Virginia Beach is ready to partner with the Virginia Department of Education and school divisions across the Commonwealth on designing and launching these models.

[00:44:15] We believe these efforts will have significant impact on our students, families, business partners, and community at large. Thank you for all that you do to support education in Virginia Beach, and have a wonderful day. Thank you. Lily Balance, followed by Candice Lucas.

[00:44:32] Is Lily here? Okay. No, Lily? Lily Balance is next, followed by Candice Lucas.

[00:44:51] So if Lily is not here, then Candice Lucas is up.

[00:45:26] Good morning, board members. - Once again, my name is Dr. Candace Lucas. I am a recognized expert in the field of special education. I attained that through over 30 years of experience as well as certifications through the VDOE as well as earned doctorate, not given, earned doctorate from Liberty University and their law program.

[00:45:50] I'm here once again to talk about the VDOEs and the Board of Education's lack of oversight supervision regarding special education. Now I've been called and referred to as an agitator and I wanted

to share this with you because I'm in good company, when you can have Sojourner Ruth and Dorothy Kennedy and several other individuals have their own book called The Agitator. So for those who call me the agitator, agitators get rid of dirt and make things clean. So that's my job.

[00:46:21] That's my God-given assignment. I heard Chairman Creasy talk about the training that the hearing officers are receiving and how they're so great. The hearing officers are extremely incompetent. They don't know the law. They're trained to rule in favor of the school divisions.

[00:46:40] In fact, hearing officer Nelson ruled in favor of families zero times in two decades. Zero times in two decades. Here in Officer Hartsoe ruled in favor of families three times in two decades. And the most recent rulings that families have received have come from me as well as Mr. Saad Alameen. We have the highest win rate regarding due process, which is why they're trying to change the law. In Virginia, because the Board of Education is failing to comply with IDEA 20

[00:47:17] USC 1412A11, IDEA 20 USC 1416, IDEA 20 USC 1415B1, and the Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act 29 USC 749, you are engaging in the conspiracy to commit felony child abuse.

[00:47:41] In Virginia, felony child abuse means when you withhold vital services, including special education services from students. Under the regulations case law for Forest Grove School District VTA, you are required to intervene the minute we tell you that a school division is violating the law. Under Board of Education of Hendrick Hudson Central School District V. Rowley, you are required to remove hearing officers who violate the law, like Ms. Nelson, told Sands Anderson Law Firm that they did not have to provide the IEP team with 3,000

[00:48:18] medical documents from Carter Gunn, a black child who was incarcerated in a facility. So I want to make sure that you understand your role. Thank you. I heard her. Don't do that.

[00:48:34] Don't do that. I know. Tell him not to do that. Thank you. I was finishing up my comment and that is an act of intimidation. So don't do that. Thank you. No, don't do that.

[00:48:46] Thank you. Kathy Halverson followed by Alex Halverson. Good morning board. Kathy Halverson, Powhatan, Virginia. I am here to speak out about. Can you hold please? They're having some technological difficulties. Okay, you may begin. Kathy Halverson, Powhatan, Virginia. I'm here to speak out on behalf of my son, myself, and the corruption that is happening here in the state of Virginia.

[00:50:53] Once again, I have been here three and a half years speaking that the board should have instituted 22.1-214E. The first letter is from Samantha Hollins giving Powhatan County two weeks, I believe, to institute a policy and send my son to private placement.

[00:51:14] That was not done. That was back in 2023. Then on August 28th, Lisa Kuhn sent a letter telling them that they had to send them no matter what in 30 days. That thing still was not done.

[00:51:31] Then I received this on from Jason Meira's Deb Love, August 31st of 2024, stating that the board should have intervened for 22.1-214. My son was out of school for three and a half years.

[00:51:49] They collected money. They are still collecting money. A December 1 count stating he is a student. The next page, pending action. I had to enroll him in Liberty because they were going to file another Chins on my husband and I.

[00:52:07] That was not happening. I was not going to lose my livelihood and my home over the corruption here in Powhatan County in the state. And I gave you some examples how the report card in

2122 is written by Tom Solzer.

[00:52:26] The next report card is from Samantha Hollins, not Samantha Hollins, Samantha Martin. She did not become president for Powhatan County until July of this year. Tell me, how is that possible?

[00:52:45] Then there's another page, Howeverson Change History. It shows that they actually went in and falsified all of my son's records, June 10th of 2024, because we were in federal court. It goes on. It says that he was supposed to be home-based in 2022, in 2021.

[00:53:08] Then they state, I did not state that I refused home-based services. How is that possible when they have him home-based? Then they have him excused. And then they said he was dropped from classes in 1028 of 2021 when he was actually a student and going to Powhatan.

[00:53:28] He didn't stop going to Powhatan County until 1117 when he was on the COVID. So when is the board going to take action and take licenses? Thank you. And Institute 22.1-214.

[00:53:44] Thank you. Alex Halverson is not here. Okay.

[00:53:52] Cheryl Sims. Go ahead. Yeah. It's in the back of your packets. There's a picture of my son. Of course, he got nervous this morning. This is a project he had to do with Liberty University. And my son ended up writing about forgiveness because of how everybody has done him.

[00:54:29] In my other school, I faced an event that taught me a lot about forgiveness. I had always, I was always friendly and nice to people and loved everyone. But I never thought how important it was to forgive others until this event happened with the workers at the school I attended.

[00:54:49] I had attended this school since I started school, and I would finish all my work and would help deliver things to classes, which I even remembered all the room numbers and teachers. However, one day in 2021, I got really upset because the teacher cussed at me.

[00:55:06] I could not handle everything with her because she always yelled at me and made me sad. The principal came to me and I just didn't know why so many people were there when all I wanted to do was finish my work.

[00:55:21] But she screamed and it hurt my ears so bad. I felt angry and sad because they were all mean to me and I still do not know what I did wrong. I have prayed since that day on how to feel and what I should do with them, and I can learn to forgive them in my life.

[00:55:41] I got upset in 2021 with the teacher because she screamed at me and called me cuss words, which I did not think was nice. I wanted to finish my work, but she yelled, and I waited till tomorrow. But she said no. I was upset because I didn't feel I had done anything wrong, but at that moment she started screaming and I yelled back because she yelled at me.

[00:56:03] I got mad and everything went crazy. My mom called for a meeting. They admitted they couldn't teach me because I learned things too quick. The years passed by and I even thought they were supposed to send a teacher, but they never did. Not one teacher called to ask how I was. I feel sad.

[00:56:22] After three years, my mom fighting with the school and education department, I remember something my mom had said about forgiveness. I would like to send a letter to the school and tell them my feelings and how much my mom and dad fought for my schooling. It was all the tears I was able to see

with my mom that made me strong and wanting to give them because now I'm being taught lots of new things.

[00:56:49] I'm so happy to finally be in school and see my grades because I can do anything I want with my faith. Now I need to get caught up to people that are my age. Through this experience, I learned that forgiveness is a powerful way to heal a relationship. It helped me understand that everyone makes mistakes. Thank you. Cheryl Sims followed by Tammy McGee. Cheryl Sims is not here.

[00:57:25] Tammy McGee. No, Tammy McGee. Gene Sokoloski. Followed by Ellie Ellis. Dr. Gene Sokoloski, Woodbridge, retired. Madam Chair, the Virginia student is required to study genocide. Page 3 of the 2023 History and Social Science Standards states, quote, the student will study the horrors

[00:58:02] of wars and genocide, unquote. However, no source on genocide is listed in the standards. My 12 March 2023 email to the board pointed out this deficiency, which was one month before the to prove the 2023 standards as my email pointed out the foundational text on genocide is the 1948 genocide convention article 2 defines genocide by specifying the four victim groups of genocide in the five acts that constitute genocide that's genocide in a nutshell which is easily grasped by students and teachers genocide convention is international law in the united states is a signatory the concept of genocide did not exist in international law and polish jewish lawyer

[00:58:41] Raphael Lemkin developed it in response to the atrocities committed by the Germans. Why do I make this point? Because standard WHII9E excludes the 1948 Genocide Convention as an important outcome of World War II. It only lists the 1948 Universal Declaration of Human Rights, which does not address genocide, nor contain the word genocide, nor is it legally binding.

[00:59:04] So who excluded the 1948 Genocide Convention in the 2023 standards? Was it the same person who, in the 2015 standards falsified two of the four victim groups of genocide. Did this person fear that if the genocide convention were included in the 2023 standards the falsified victim groups in the 2015 standards would be discovered? National and ethnic groups were erased and in their place cultural and political groups were inserted. Poles are a national and ethnic group. Roma are an ethnic group. They were targeted for and subjected to genocide just as European Jews were and Poles

[00:59:41] were subjected to genocide well before Polish and other European Jews. This falsification was also in the first draft of the 2023 standards and it was further endorsed by the Governor's Commission on Combating Anti-Semitism in Virginia on page 19 of his report. Is it the same person who in the 2023 standards excluded Poles in Roma as Hitler's genocide victims and only included European Jews?

[01:00:06] The student is required to study genocide, not the genocide of one group. In the case of World war ii in europe this undeniably requires the inclusion of hitler's genocide of poles in roma i respectfully request that you investigate who wrote this standard and determine if pardon me and determine if it was the result of in incompetence or intent and i further request that you correct the standard by inserting the 1948 genocide convention as an important outcome

[01:00:36] of world war ii thank you thank you ellie ellis followed by helen woo ellie ellis here helen woo My name is Helen Wu. I live in Linton, Virginia, and I'm the headmistress of Virginia International Academy.

[01:01:16] And here I have Roy Manuel and Miyako Manuel with me. And I'm here to, thank you, looking for help desperately and some urgent help. And let me introduce my school a little bit.

[01:01:32] My school was founded in 2013, and we provide education to international students. and we have been educated almost close to 300 students and most of them are in college or graduate school and some already got a job in the U.S. right now.

[01:01:47] And they went to UVA, Virginia Tech, a lot of good schools including Columbia, Harvard, UPenn, those are schools. So we did provide a good education. Our parents' satisfaction rate is 100% at this point. And this year when we relocate our campus to Moratown, which is a very small place in Sharon, Shenandoah County and we we are doing the renovation and the we're going to build a new gym.

[01:02:16] The whole investment is about a four million dollars and we hope to go back to the full operation in the fall and then we found a big problem. We found that our accreditation agency we used before Cognia was not recognized by VCPE so we we talked to VCPE and we found there's a list of the approved agency. We contact them and none of them will give us enough time to be able to get the accreditation and to be in full operation in the fall. So we're in trouble now. And we did the full economic impact analysis by professional economists and our whole project will create 93

[01:02:56] jobs. So the whole county, including the board of supervisors in our county, they fully support us. they really want to see this happen. And then also we we talked to different agencies and some of them want to help us. So I'm here desperately looking for help to see if I can get any kind of way to put our school back into operation either temporarily provisional or reinstatement of our membership with VCPE. The reason we lost that was because in 2019 I got a breast cancer so I moved all the office admin work to the other person and he resigned during covid time so the ball

[01:03:34] got dropped so i do take that as my responsibility but i don't know what to do now and when i told people that i'm coming here to the board all our teachers our parents and also the county they want to provide a fully support so i'm here looking for help i hope that we can get whatever method I can get from the board. Thank you so much. Andrea Donneville followed by Dr. Laura

[01:04:03] Easter. Andrea Donneville. Laura Easter. Good morning. Good morning. My name is Dr. Laura Easter

[01:04:52] and I'm the Chief Operating Officer for Elk Hill. I'm here today to ask for your support in making iTeach available to private specialized day schools. I was very disappointed that it was moved from today's agenda because the need for this program is urgent and great. Elk Hill is a non-profit serving mental health, behavioral, and special education needs of children and families in central Virginia, including three specialized private day schools. Specialized private day schools serve public school special education students whose needs are not being successfully met in their home school. Day schools are licensed by VDOE and accredited by VASEF.

[01:05:31] Students are referred to us by their public school. Placement is written in their IEP and the goal is for them to gain the skills needed to return to their public school. They're funded by their localities. Students are most often placed with us because in addition to their learning differences they have co-occurring mental health and behavioral challenges. So these are not only public school students but some of the most challenging. Multiple suspensions for serious behavior infractions is a common reason for referrals to a private day school. Yet we compete

[01:06:06] for the same pool of licensed special education teachers as the public schools, but we can't be competitive with public school salaries and benefits. As the behavioral and mental health challenges of

our students have intensified over the past five years, finding qualified special education teachers has become even more difficult. Our small class sizes mean that to operate efficiently, we need special education teachers licensed K-12 so they can teach a variety of classes and are not limited to subject-specific courses. This further decreases an already small

[01:06:43] applicant pool. iTeach fills a crucial need for providing our students with high-quality teachers who not only can address their learning differences, but who also have an understanding and empathy for students with significant mental health and behavioral issues. iTeach would provide an affordable and time-efficient pathway for some of our most dedicated and skilled staff to become licensed special education teachers, including behavioral staff, mental health professionals, and career switchers. Although Elkill prides itself on retaining staff long-term,

[01:07:19] we recognize the intense academic, emotional, and behavioral needs of our students result in burnout for our teachers in about five years. However, most remain in the field, most of them go to the public school thus the teachers we create in specialized private day schools will likely benefit special education students across virginia for years to come

[01:07:41] thank you thank you farrah fant followed by winnie gibson good morning board members um my name's farrah i'm 19 years old but please yeah um my name's farrah i'm 19 years old i'm here to support

[01:08:13] bill 2774 about parental notification of in-school overdoses um i just want to share a little bit of my testimony um i in i went to harrisonburg high school in about 10th grade i was introduced to fentanyl i was on track to graduate a year early with an advanced diploma but when i tried this drug i didn't really know what it was it wasn't introduced to me um like a hard drug it was like a casual thing and I quickly spiraled into a full out addiction it took my life over and it just

[01:08:52] quickly caused my life to spiral I almost died multiple times I overdosed multiple times I mean this is a very rampant issue in this school the teachers knew what was going on it was kind of openly being done there's kids walking down the hallways vaping and it's just kind of being blatantly ignored. So by the time I was physically dependent on this, my mom had no idea that she was losing her child. She had no idea what I was being exposed to. So I just really

[01:09:29] support this bill. Parents need to know what's going on. Teachers need to know how to administer Narcan. They need to know, they need to be provided with Narcan. And I just am here to support that. There was multiple times my mom reached out to the school and they just said, well, we don't really have time to deal with this. They pushed it under the rug and it's very urgent.

[01:09:56] There's kids dying. I would argue that this is the most important issue here that we have to deal with because these kids aren't even having the chance to get through school and grow into an adulthood, they're not even being educated on what this is. So I've been following this through the House and the Senate, and prayerfully it passed through them, and I just ask for you guys to support. It's very, very important, and I thank you for your support. By the grace of God, I was pulled out of this addiction. Most kids, once they fall into this, they're

[01:10:33] done. It was all I wanted. If it wasn't for God, I would probably be dead. And many kids, many of my friends have passed because of this substance. It's being mixed into marijuana. It's as easy to get as alcohol and weed. So I strongly urge you all to support this. And yeah, thank you.

[01:11:02] - Winnie Gibson, is Winnie Gibson here? Okay, at this time we'll take any other members of the audience who would like to speak publicly. You can line up behind the microphone.

[01:11:19] If there is no one, then we will close the public comment period.

[01:11:25] And at this time, we'll take a five minute break, please.

[01:16:24] Okay, we are back and we are moving into the consent agenda. Just to make a note here, the consent agenda item E for math, for which there's a corresponding item R. Item E is the phase one approval. Item R is first review of the phase two approval.

[01:16:43] So is there a motion to waive first review and approve the items on the consent agenda? Okay, Dr. Northern, Ms. Kilgore, Dr. Hanson, Ms. McPherson, Ms. Holton, and chair votes aye.

[01:17:04] Okay, moving on to item G. First and final review of school connected overdose parent notification guidelines. Dr. Armstrong. - Morning, Madam President and board members. We have the superintendent.

[01:17:19] We recommend that the Board of Education approve the guidelines on school-connected overdose policies, response, and parental notification following our presentation yesterday and dialogue on first and final review. Is there a motion to waive first review and approve the guidelines on school-connected overdose policies, response, and parental notification?

[01:17:43] I have an alternative motion. Sultan? I'd like to move that the guidelines be accepted. Well, and actually, maybe discussion, maybe I can comment first, may I, before I make my motion?

[01:17:59] Well, there's no motion. Can we discuss the item? Yeah. Briefly. Thank you. And this is brief. I'm grateful. I think the department has done a terrific job bringing folks together and seeking public feedback on this important topic.

[01:18:15] It's a challenging topic to figure out how best to help our students in such a tragic circumstance. This young woman who bravely shared her story with us today reminds us how important it is.

[01:18:31] And I know people across the Commonwealth are trying to figure out how to best address it. We've had some success, and the governor's executive order and other actions have helped. And I'm grateful for all of that. AND I THINK THESE GUIDLINES WILL HELP.

[01:18:49] THE GUIDLINES CONTAIN TWO SENTENCES THAT ARE ACTUALLY IN DISPUTE AND UNNECESSARY TO THE IMPORT OF THE GUIDLINES. AND I DRAW MY COLLEAGUES ATTENTION TO THE LANGUAGE IN THE INTRODUCTION.

[01:19:07] THERE ARE TWO LINES -- THREE SENTENCES, EXCUSE ME -- AT THE END OF THE SECOND PARAGRAPH OF THE INTRODUCTION OF THE GUIDLINES. That refer to some specific facts that happened in Loudoun County in the fall of October of 23, referencing how many overdoses occurred and where and when, and also suggesting that parents were not notified of these life endangering events until at least 20 days later.

[01:19:41] And those facts, I think it's important for the board to understand that those facts are in dispute. The long time, excuse me, the superintendent in Loudoun, who was previously a long time, highly

respected superintendent in Virginia Beach, responsible for some of the important innovations we were hearing from yesterday in Virginia Beach and also in the public comment today,

[01:20:09] Somebody whose integrity is beyond question has written a letter to Dr. Coons indicating that that information is not accurate. And I think the gist of the dispute is whether the notice that was sent to families was specific enough.

[01:20:34] And divisions and principals are trying to balance student privacy with student safety. And just to be clear, the notices that are in dispute were not, the question isn't whether the parents of the child involved were notified.

[01:20:50] That is not part of this, that's not the problem at all here. The problem was what notice was sent to the community more broadly. And the notice that was sent in Loudoun was more general than the guidelines under consideration would require.

[01:21:10] And the guidelines requiring much more specific and much more prompt notification, I think, makes sense. And I'm all on board. And I know that the superintendent in Loudoun is on board and has sent a letter to Dr. Coons indicating.

[01:21:27] But he specifically is disputing these facts. And it just, I have never seen guidelines reference a specific division and specific events and specific students the way these guidelines, I mean, it doesn't reference the students by name, but specific events in this way.

[01:21:47] It adds nothing to the guidelines. It's highly inappropriate to include this kind of specific language in guidelines. It adds nothing to the guideline content. And so I would encourage the board to, and I'm prepared to make a motion, to accept the guidelines deleting those three sentences that are in dispute.

[01:22:08] I do have the letter from Dr. Spence. I just received it from Dr. Kunz this morning, and I'm happy to read it out loud. I especially think that it's inappropriate for this board to include that language in those guidelines on first and final review today without reviewing the letter from Dr.

[01:22:27] You don't have it in front of you, we can get it to you, or I can read it aloud if people want to. But specifically, he says, I also ask that you correct information. He talks about the number of events and whether they were in school or out of school and suspected versus confirmed overdose.

[01:22:43] That's some of the factual dispute. But then he specifically says, I also ask that you correct information on page three of the model guidance, specifically the introduction states that LCPS did not notify parents until 20 days later. This is not true. I have shared similar information with others.

[01:23:01] And frankly, I question why LCPS must specifically be named at all in VDOE's guidance or news release. I find this disappointing at best, and I'm not at all clear on how this enhances the model guidance in any way. So I'm not asking that we resolve this factual dispute here today.

[01:23:18] I'm just saying there's no reason for us to include language, specifically naming and calling out a division over facts that are in dispute in model guidance mr hanson i cannot support no this alternative i do think there are law enforcement and other officials who have come out very powerfully in explaining the 20-day challenge and don't have a problem i think it

[01:23:54] actually is helpful to us to identify illustrations of the problem that we are trying to address with these overdose guidelines so I would not support Ms. Holton's offer here. Dr. Coons. So the board

knows the comments that were recorded by Dr. Spence who attended a public comment hearing and multiple families who refuted his comments are in your folder. Loudoun County continues to object to language used by other officials summing up the number of related overdoses in a set number

[01:24:31] of time period that the division had last year. Superintendent Spence says that there were not nine related overdoses. The Loudoun County Sheriff says there were actually 11. Recognizing the dispute between the school superintendent and the Loudoun County Sheriff, the guy before the board today does not cite any definitive number of the related school overdoses. Regardless of whether the number is 9 or 11, there were a shocking number of school related overdoses in Loudoun County last year and parents must be notified when these occur in around in their schools and the parents who were in the public comment from Loudoun

[01:25:07] County were explicit with Dr. Armstrong and I about the importance that we heard. We also heard from a student today about the critical nature of communicating with our families and that that did not happen from Loudoun County as you'll see in your public comment folder. Just if I may respond the letter from Dr. Spence, as you know, Dr. Coons, the letter from Dr. Spence was directed to you, not to the board, and therefore you declined my request to place it in the public comment folder to make it available to all the board members. But that letter, it's not simply the

[01:25:42] numbers that's in dispute, it's what notice was sent. And Dr. Spence quotes extensively from a notice that was sent before the governor's executive order to the parents of the entire school. And he also reaffirms that none of this is, he is completely supportive of the efforts to, of the content of the guidelines. This is not about what we should be doing going forward. I think everybody is in agreement that we want, this guidance, guidelines helps reconcile the challenges and gives schools guidance on how to reconcile the balance between

[01:26:20] student privacy and student safety and and is fully on board with that uh i've i've never seen and i i i ask that you give me an example of a guideline document we have ever issued from this board that names a division and specific incidents in this kind of way thank you it hadn't happened is there a motion to waive first review and approve the guidelines on school connected overdose policies response and parental notification so my motion is to approve a minute line you need to be recognized first thank you i'd like to make a motion i i would like to

[01:26:59] make a motion i think i spoke a minute no no i recognize the next speaker mr hansen i spoke first madam president and i would like to make my motion actually the you can make a substitute motion i would like to make a substitute so we have to have a second to his motion and then you can make a substitute motion first so there is a motion on the floor to waive first review and approve the

[01:27:29] guidelines is there a second no second okay i would like to make a substitute motion i would like to make a motion miss holton i would like to make a motion that we approve the guidelines as written with the language in the second paragraph starting the order was made through

[01:27:55] the language 20 days later three sentences deleted okay so we would be removing the order was made to the motion is the order was made to and move through four sentences beginning with the order was made so you would strike the order was made in direct response to nine students who overdosed

[01:28:31] on fentanyl from the same high school in loudon county in october 2023 four of the student overdoses happened while at school, the rest occurred off campus. Three of the students who overdosed on campus were given the anti-overdose drug naloxone and school staff also performed CPR on two of those students.

[01:28:57] Parents were not notified of these life-endangering events until at least 20 days later. Is that your motion? - Yes, that's the language that contains the disputed facts and that's my motion. Okay.

[01:29:13] - Madam President, can I speak to the motion? - Discussion, Ms. McPherson. - The reason that I support the substitute motion is I don't, is that I don't want any students to be unfairly identified in this situation.

[01:29:34] It's difficult enough to have students come forward and support provisions such as this and identifying the school and the number of students, I think doesn't promote the regulation And I'm concerned about students talking about who it was, you know, as this all becomes public and we move into a different direction.

[01:29:56] I think we accomplish what we want to accomplish by having the guidelines. Mr. Hanson. I would respectfully suggest, though, that students are not being identified here. This is identifying bad management, lack of leadership, and attention to such a critical issue to protect children, to protect parents, to protect communities.

[01:30:23] And I just think that this might, Ms. Holton's comment about not being referenced before, I don't know that because that's a fact, but I also don't think that we've had such a critical concentration of events that are referenced in this language in the history of what I've seen living in the Commonwealth since 1964.

[01:30:49] So I think it's, again, incredibly appropriate and important to reference those things will help us protect students protect parents and to bring the public awareness to this issue madam president um i'm checking with the ends to see if they have comments first anyone have a comment down here no okay miss mcpherson i mean publicly we have the ability to discipline any superintendent

[01:31:23] there's a process for that if we felt like there was um behavior i mean i'm not saying a week as as a board. But I'm saying there's a process for correcting what we believe to be bad behavior but as it relates to policy and going forward I just don't think that that adds anything to it. I think that the Commonwealth is aware of the fact that this has been an issue and that we're trying to deal with the issue. I just don't think that it adds anything to it. Okay so a substitute motion has been made and seconded. We're voting on the substitute motion to remove those four sentences

[01:31:59] that were read earlier. Dr. Northern. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. Mr. Hanson. No. Ms. McPherson. Aye. Ms. Holton. Aye. Chair votes no. That motion passes four to two.

[01:32:21] H. First and final review of policy for calculating students with limited and or interrupted formal education on the on-time graduation rate in accordance with chapter 623 of the Acts of Assembly of 2024. Dr. Myers. Madam President, members of the board, Dr. Coons. I'm here this morning to tell you about a law that was enacted with the 2024 General Assembly.

[01:32:49] In order to encourage EL SLIFE students to stay in high school and graduate, the General Assembly has directed the board to change how SLIFE students are counted in Virginia's on-time

graduation and dropout rates. The board is required to adopt a policy that will not include SLIFE students in the calculation if they have not attended at least two semesters of high school. As a result, we are seeking to adopt this policy where the VDOE data team will remove any student that has not attended high school for at least two semesters from the denominator when calculating on-time graduation and dropout rates. Pretty straightforward with

[01:33:28] what they've directed us to do, so we're here today to try to get that completed. Okay, is there a motion to waive first review and approve the adoption of this resolution and amendments to guidance document any discussion dr northern miss kilgore mr hanson miss mcpherson miss holton aye and chair votes aye dr myers item i first and final review of the recommendation regarding

[01:34:03] literacy loan applications and approval for the release of of loan funds miss burda good morning president creasy members of the board dr coons vdoe conducted one loan application process in fiscal year 2023 and two loan application processes during fiscal year 2024 for school divisions to apply for construction loans through the literary fund. Two school divisions before you today, Giles and Roanoke counties, have applied for the loans in these three open application periods and have now submitted all the required documentation needed for their requests and the loans to be released by the board. The item requests that the board approve the release of

[01:34:43] two literary loans as requested by the two applicant school divisions as follows, a loan requested by Giles County to add a secure entryway and elevator refurbishment at Narrows Elementary Middle School. Giles is requesting a literary fund loan in the amount of $650,000 payable over 30 years and is eligible for a 2% annual loan interest rate. A loan is requested by Roanoke County Schools to build Roanoke Career Technical Education Center at the Dana Burton Center for Arts and Technology site. Roanoke County is requesting a literary loan for the

[01:35:20] project in the amount of $25 million, payable over 20 years, and is eligible for a 3% annual loan interest rate. Both of these projects are attached to your agenda as their applications. It is recommended today that the board waive first review and approve the release of the two literary fund loans as requested by the two applicant schools school divisions based on the loan amounts terms and eligible annual interest rates requested in their loan applications and in your executive summary happy to entertain any questions if you have any okay is there a motion to waive first review and approve the release of the two literary fund loans requested by the

[01:35:58] two applicant school divisions based on the loan amounts terms and eligible annual interest rates requested in their loan applications and as presented in

[01:36:08] this item. No. Dr. Northern, or I'm sorry, is there any discussion? Dr. Northern, Ms. Kilgore, Mr. Hanson, Ms. McPherson, Ms. Holton? Aye. Chair votes aye. Thank you. Item J, first and final review of guidelines for distributing National Board Certification Incentive Awards. Mr. Gilstrap. President Creasy, Dr. Coons, members of the board, I bring good news from our December meeting when we discussed National Board Certification

[01:36:45] in the funding whether it was going to be enough. One of the requests you had was to bring recommendations on how to spend the money in anticipation that we would not have enough to meet the needs. As you can see through the executive summary portions, we actually have $213,000 beyond what our requested number is at this point. We do anticipate that there could be a few school divisions that did

not submit on time and that money could be consumed by those requests. I also wanted to point out on this information, it's asterisk on here, but I'll

[01:37:21] point it out that we did have initial awards in January, but there were a few divisions that made adjustments, and that is calculated in here with about $247,000 to the initial and continuing status. Page three of your documents starts the guidance document that we have, the guidelines for in the event that we would not have enough money and we did incorporate all your suggestions within this document the procedures to fill all awards would be where you would notice that if you were to review that section there and

[01:37:58] finally the action requested for this year's budget language we had to take priority to to fund the initial which we already have and the continuing which we already have we have our plan for how we would fund the remaining and upon your guidance. We will do that immediately. The Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board of Education accept for first review and final review the request to revise the guidelines, as you can see in this document, for distributing National Board Certification Incentive Awards. Thank you, Mr.

[01:38:33] Gilstrap. And we also appreciate your responsiveness within the executive summary that you provided, that the Board had requested that particular data and information, and so thank you so much for for that. So is there a motion to waive first review and approve the revisions to the guidelines for distributing national board certification incentive awards any discussion miss holton just to say thank you to mr gilstrap

[01:39:06] for hard work making it work thanks any other discussion dr northern miss kilgore mr hanson miss mcpherson miss holton i chair votes i okay item k first and final review of mastery level standard setting review committee process. Ms. Cooper. Good morning, President Creasy, members of the board, and Dr. Coons. As you all heard yesterday, this is the first time

[01:39:40] the standard setting review process has been brought to the board. We sought input from our technical advisory committee, the Center for Assessment, and the National Assessment Governing Board on this process. That includes four key phases: the selection, training, convening, and input of the standard setting process the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board receive for first and final review the proposed recommendation for this standard setting committee dr cooper you meant the committee process the selection of the committee

[01:40:18] okay okay is there a motion to wave first review and approve the proposed recommendation for the mastery level standard setting process the committee process time for discussion first once there's a motion i'll move the motion is there any discussion miss holton yes so first if i can just clarify am i correct that what we're being asked to approve today is simply the committee process that the review process that the committee will be assisting us with that's

[01:40:56] on for only first review later on the agenda that's correct thank you uh and as to the committee process. Can Dr. Coons or M can one of you address we heard from Mr. Dr. Domolesky yesterday, some thoughts about the criteria for the non teacher participants. He suggested that in other states that have typically been geographically geographic cross sections demographic cross sections have

[01:41:33] You've included a cross-section across different careers and also included advocates for special education English language learners. I don't see any of that in the guideline document, but can you affirm

what the department's attention is on that today?

[01:41:53] Absolutely. Dr. Demoleski is closely aligned with us. We are also working with national experts at NAGME to make sure that we are using best practices that are representative geographically. We have always used geographic representation, but the additional components as he spoke to the business members, higher education and diverse representation from parents and educators is incredibly important.

[01:42:20] Also those minimum criteria of knowing and having representation of the content area, children and what an assessment entails will be part of that application process. So just to be clear that we'll-- Ms. Holton. Thank you. We'll include demographic, cross-section, and also representation of ELL and special ed.

[01:42:41] Those were some of Dr. Domolesky's comments yesterday. I just wanted to make sure that that's part of your criteria. I don't know about the demographics. I will have to get back to you on the demographics. All the other things are part of the rubric process. Well, I would just encourage the department-- Ms. Holton.

[01:42:59] I would just encourage the department the value of democratic, as Dr. Domolesky said yesterday, process is key to having support for the outcome. That there's no magic to one way of determining these standard setting versus another, but that having the process have integrity is key and having a cross-section that's representative of the Commonwealth demographically, economically, et cetera, is at least as important as the other criteria.

[01:43:36] - Thank you. - Madam President. - Ms. McPherson. - Is it also possible, just like we did with workforce development, if the board wants to make some recommendations or review the list or give some possible names for them to consider, would that be acceptable?

[01:43:53] - Dr. Cairns. - We'd be happy to pass out the application process and make sure that the board is aware of that so you can encourage different stakeholders to be part of that. THE BOARD IS ALSO WELCOME TO BE PART OF THAT PROCESS AS WELL. I ALSO HAVE ONE OTHER QUESTION, MADAM PRESIDENT? MS. HOLTON?

[01:44:10] SO, AND THE OTHER THING THAT WE DISCUSSED, AND I DON'T -- I'M MEANING TO HELP MAKE THIS PROCESS AS SUCCESSFUL AS POSSIBLE WITH THIS COMMENT.

[01:44:25] THERE WAS A DISCUSSION YESTERDAY ABOUT THE TIMING, AND I UNDERSTOOD FROM DR. DOMOLESKI, AND I'M NOT SURE WHETHER THIS IS APPROPRIATE TO THIS ITEM OR LATER, BUT I'LL RAISE IT here because it may be relevant to this item, that Dr. Domolesky suggested that the best way to do standard setting with an ID matching method is to have a full operational test administration. Given that we've made changes in our tests and our standards and our tests this year, and that we've waited this long, I'm curious as to why we're not waiting one

[01:44:59] more months so that we can have the full test administration available rather than and if we don't have the full test administration available what are the department's plans what are we going to do if we don't if you could just hold that question because that's not part of this particular item and I really don't think that it's appropriate to confuse the board members on what we're actually voting on for this particular item so if you can hold that comment for the coming item so so just to be clear this process

setting up the committees it does have some references to schedules sorry it has some reference to schedules but those schedules aren't binding in other words

[01:45:36] if we decide on a slower process this item won't bind us on that dr coons this is the process for selecting the committee not the dates the committee will be required to attend thank you okay so we have a motion made and seconded to waive first review and approve the proposed recommendation for the mastery level standard setting process committee process. Dr. Northern, Ms. Kilgore, Mr. Hanson, Ms. McPherson, Ms. Holton. Aye. And chair votes aye. Item L.

[01:46:16] First and final review of guidance documents for reduction. Mr. Chapman. Good morning President Creasy, members of the board, Superintendent Koons. This item I think is relatively simple. As most of you know we have been on a a clean of our guidance document role over the past year and what we have here is two documents that we believe should be removed from the list of certified guidance documents that the board has one of those the first the guidelines on the management of students collect scholastic record in the public schools of virginia is actually not

[01:46:51] a document that we think ever went to the board we can't find any record of that but since it's now been certified by the board we think it's appropriate to bring that to the board just to make sure that um that the board approves of removing it um the second document the uh economics education financial literacy objects and correlations this is really just a kind of a crosswalk document between uh you know what used to be um what sorry now has an economics sol and the math sol which is of course out of date since the board has approved new sol material

[01:47:27] Both of these documents are the subject of revisions that we think removing them from town hall, because we don't think they meet the definition of clear up some process issues for the for the department. The guidelines for management of students scholastic records, we actually have a leg a legislatively mandated change that we have to do.

[01:47:44] And so we, since we were looking at the document, we don't think it meets the definition of a guidance document we would, you know, want to request permission to remove it. And the same thing since the economics document is an SOL document and the SOLs by statute are not regulations.

[01:48:00] We don't think this is appropriate for town hall. But that document is under revision as well in order to make sure it's aligned with the new math standards. Thank you, Mr. Chapman. Is there a motion to waive first review and approve this item and remove the guidance document identified from town hall?

[01:48:18] Any discussion? Dr. Northern? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. McPherson?

[01:48:29] Ms. Holton, chair votes aye. Okay, item M, you're still up. Thank you. First and final review, the finalization of periodic reviews of regulations. Thank you, President Creasy. Yes, this item is becoming a regular for the board. We are just closing out periodic reviews. We do have some recommendations for action as a result of these periodic reviews, most of which I will describe as very modest. I believe three of the chapters we're recommending retain as is just because they're required by statute, or they're currently serving their purpose.

[01:49:01] There are a couple of minor edits that we would like to bring back in future actions for the board to consider. The management of student scholastic records, we think this chapter basically devolves into requiring school divisions to follow FERPA.

[01:49:17] And so we think that this can be condensed fairly significantly to require the same thing and the same content, but be moved under Chapter 720, which is the regulations governing local school boards and school divisions. So same content, just shorter and in a single location, so we don't have as many open chapters for the board.

[01:49:35] We believe that 340, which are regulations governing driver education, in the process of the periodic review, we located one issue that has been changed from the DMV side, which is the difference between our regs requiring, I think, a 90-day temporary driver's license, but that has been lengthened to 180 days through DMV.

[01:49:57] And so we would like to align the board's regulations with the current DMV policy and how they issue those. The regulations governing division superintendents of schools. There's actually a section of this chapter outlining qualifications for the superintendent that conflict with Chapter 23 of the licensure regulations for school personnel.

[01:50:18] So we think that Section 10 should be stricken. It appears that that was the case through a reg action about 10 years ago, but that regulatory action was never finalized. And so we think we can remove the conflict with Chapter 23 and make sure that the board's regulations are a little bit more clear.

[01:50:34] And then we have a similar issue with 410, which is our regulations governing allowable credit for teaching experience. This chapter really serves as a definition within Chapter 23. And so we think the same thing should apply, that we can just move this little section of this chapter into Chapter 23 as a definition of allowable teaching experience.

[01:50:54] And so it will serve the purpose within the regulatory chapter it appears to be amending. But again, all of those will be the subject of future actions that we will bring back to the board. This is just requesting to close the periodic reviews. Is there a motion to waive first review and approve the closing of the periodic reviews on the regulatory chapters identified in this item as presented to the board?

[01:51:20] Any discussion? Dr. Northern? Ms. Kilgore? Mr. Hanson? Ms. McPherson? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. And chair votes aye. Item N, Dr. Armstrong. Thank you, Mr. Chapman.

[01:51:38] Final review of high-quality work-based learning definition, experiences, and evaluation criteria. Thank you, Madam President and Board members. Following our December work session as well as yesterday's presentation and discussion, I would like to recommend that the Board approve the high-quality work-based learning definition, experiences, and evaluation criteria today on final review.

[01:52:00] Okay. Is there a motion to approve the high-quality work-based learning definition, experiences, and evaluation criteria? Is there any discussion? Dr. Northern, Ms. Kilgore, Mr. Hansen, Ms. McPherson, Ms. Holton?

[01:52:24] Aye. Chair votes aye. Okay. Item O, first review of seat time flexibility notice. Dr. Armstrong. Thank you, Madam President. Again, following yesterday's presentation and dialogue, we would like to recommend that the board receive the seat time flexibility notice on first review in anticipation of our March meeting for final review.

[01:52:47] Thank you. We will accept this item for first review and see you in March. Item P, Mr. Chapman is up again. First review of proposed stage to align with item 138 of Chapter 2 of the Acts of Assembly 2022 Special Session 1, 8VAC 20-671.

[01:53:11] Thank you so much, President Creasy, members of the board, Superintendent Koons. This is the proposed stage of a NORA that was opened about six months ago, all of which is designed to fulfill a legislative mandate in order to make, develop and promulgate regulations for private special education day schools on restraint and seclusion that establish the same requirements for restraint and seclusion as those for public schools. This regulatory action actually been before the board in a few different forms. It was originally a fast track action that was approved back at the beginning of 2022 i believe got stuck in executive branch review and because it was dealing with a subject matter

[01:53:49] that was considered controversial by dpb came back and opened the full regulatory process the board has approved text that has not changed since 2022 is designed to fulfill that legislative mandate we're basically just taking the exact same requirements that are available for public schools and making those those same requirements for private special education day schools we've We've worked with the attorney general's office on this language, and so this is the first review of the proposed stage.

[01:54:17] After it comes back for the second review of the proposed stage, next month, it'll go out for the 60-day public comment. - Thank you, Mr. Chapman. We will accept this item for first review and see you in March.

[01:54:35] Let's do item Q, and then we're gonna take a quick break after item Q.

[01:54:43] Is Ms. Cooper here?

[01:55:16] We can take a break now if you guys want.

[01:55:18] go ahead and do that we'll take our five minute break now sorry give you guys a second um so

[02:05:06] dr wallace you are doing item q please okay good after good morning president creasy members of the board and dr coons i'm here to present the first review of the grade six through eight virginia literacy act supplemental and intervention program guides these guides have been reviewed by the university of virginia through the virginia literacy partnership as required by the virginia literacy act and the list provides school divisions with approved options that have met the bar for quality through the materials review process divisions can select supplemental programs in

[02:05:41] six through eight to support additional time on literacy skills and also intervention curricula for students who need additional support to master key skills you have seen these program guides in previous forms for k through five this brings to you a list for grades six through eight for first review and we recommend that the board receive for first review this recommendation recommended list for both six through eight intervention instructional programs and supplemental instructional programs to comply with the vla you have both program guides in your packets as

[02:06:16] attachments thank you so much we will accept this item for first review and see you in march and then you also have our correct correct first review of additional proposed state approved textbooks and instructional materials for k-12 mathematics yes and so you have already approved one list of math textbooks and so we're gracious for that we are excited to expand our list of instructional materials so you know that there is a process by which we go through that is your

[02:06:54] board approved process for review of textbooks and instructional materials at the october meeting the board suggested that we expand and possibly open up an additional cycle for review of the math textbooks to offer the field greater options and so that is what we have done. We do have the review

timeline in your packet and you can see we've really been working on this for about a year to bring you quality instruction materials in math and we're excited that the list was able to expand with this last cycle of review. I would like to give a shout out to our 90 plus educators and

[02:07:30] Virginia Department of Education staff who took time individually to review materials and then come together for a consensus review with the additional materials pretty much in record time since the October board meeting and they have done so we've all with an additional validation step to the textbook and instructional materials review process with a national expert with expertise in high quality instruction materials and curriculum that added an additional layer of review to make sure that we're providing quality products to our school divisions and so we did have a materials

[02:08:06] rubric that was in alignment with the correlation to the standards of learning and then also a rubric on instructional design and support which reflects those core instructional practices that teachers can expect with a good quality high quality instructional materials or curriculum based program we went through of course your the regular textbook i won't go through all the bullets on the slide but we went through the regular process to solicit additional reviewers for this last review and then provided additional publisher support this time so not only did we

[02:08:44] reach out to publishers soliciting for them to present materials for review but we provided them with a chart that compared the common core standards to virginia standards so that we could better align their products that exist with the virginia standards thus giving us a greater pool to review in this last cycle and so following uh today's recommendation for first review there'll be a 30-day public comment period and then we would bring these materials back to you for final review in march thank you dr wallace we will accept this item on first review and again

[02:09:22] this is the continuation from item e of the consent agenda earlier but for the second phase so thank you very much thank you okay item s miss cooper first review of mastery level standard setting review process good morning over the past three years the board has prioritized raising expectations for virginia students through the adoption of more rigorous standards of learning and through the approval of a new school performance and support framework

[02:09:58] videoe has also redesigned summative assessments to be more innovative and fully measure the rigor of the new standards. Building on this foundation the board must set new assessment cut scores on these summative assessments to align proficiency to the increasing demands of the workplace and benchmark to the highest definitions in the nation. Today we have for first review the recommendation for the standard setting process of shifting from the ANGOF method to the ID method during a standard setting. The superintendent recommends that the board receive this for first

[02:10:32] review the proposed recommendation of the standard setting process you so we will accept this item for first review and see you in March are we not going to have a presentation today we had we had a presentation yesterday from dr.

[02:10:54] Domolesky but I don't think we went through the process with him at any length yesterday and assuming for the public sake and our sake we were gonna have go through it today how are we proceeding today just being one of our most important responsibilities I can share this was the presentation that's displayed right now is the presentation that Dr. Domolesky did yesterday but to recap the training process that I talked through with the other item is really to make sure that all of the selected committee members are getting ready to prepare for that standard setting convening so they're going

[02:11:31] through multiple types of training the first type of training that's specifically provided to the community members is to get them a foundation of the SOLs what our assessment design process looks like why we do standard setting and then all of the committee members will go through additional training on the item types they'll also do a pilot run for the community members and then everyone on the committees will do a dress rehearsal to make sure that they're prepared for the entire convening process of setting the recommendations for the cut scores that process will um use the

[02:12:07] and goff not the angoff method but the id method matching from yesterday that dr domolesky shared that process also included a timeline of going from the committee training which is in april the convenings in may the first and final review of this cut scores in june and july and then school divisions would receive training materials and resources and then preliminary data at the end of the summer and early fall dr coons i don't think the board has voted on what method yet i think that's the first review and this is a high level so you're going over the structured

[02:12:45] process but the board needs to vote on what method so i don't want to make an assumption i just want to back that statement up just a little bit the board will vote final review next time on the type of method as dr domolesky said the tack is meeting with us monthly they're coming in next week. We will continue to get to the granularity of the process. Dr. Domolesky reminded the board that we are asking for first review and recommending the ID matching, which is what I think Ms. Cooper meant, is that that is the intent is to move forward based on the board's decision for final

[02:13:19] review in March. Any further questions or comments on this? Ms. Holton. So I thought, and maybe I'm just mixing myself up, but I thought I had seen something in the materials, and if not, I would appreciate you helping us today understand you had set out the process that this is first review we're not being asked to vote on it today but the process and the timeline for what what's going to happen between now and it was there not a presentation a separate presentation or a separate document that set that out help me find that those are all draft materials as part of the

[02:13:57] process to make sure the board is informed of the voting timeline this is the first review Dr. Domolesky was reviewing the methodology which is under first review. We will bring, as M mentioned yesterday, it is critical for the board and as you mentioned for the board to be engaged at every step of that process. M wanted to draft that process out for you. Obviously this is first review. There is no decision point on specific dates that will be brought today because we are talking about the first review of the process and the methodology. So there's not a document that sets out I'm sorry there's not a document that sets out

[02:14:34] those that timeline I thought I'm line was in a one of the presentations yesterday help me to understand where it is just so I can find it I think you're referring to the timeline that was in it was attached to the other item which had the committee selection process and timeline is it on today or was it on yes I was yesterday there were there were I think it was the second to last slide and it outlined the months in which those things would take place so So can we pull that up? I think it would be helpful. And if not, I can I can ask my question

[02:15:07] while this would be an attachment to the work session item yesterday. Is that if we can should be. Can we identify what that was so that it can be pulled up? It was the standard setting committee selection process presentation from yesterday. It wasn't the Domolesky

[02:15:32] presentation. It was a separate item, was it? Thank you. That's because we really didn't go through that yesterday unless I missed it. The name of the presentation was Virginia's

[02:16:09] proposed standard setting plan. Perfect. Thank you. Okay. That's the one. I'm still not finding it on my machine, but I can see it up there. There you go. So, and this is part of what we're going to be asked to approve next month. Is that correct? Yes. Yes. Okay. So, first, just,

[02:16:43] Well, one technical thing, the item for today, the item, there were a number of references to math experts when you mean to be referring to math or literacy or science experts as appropriate, I think.

[02:17:01] So that's just a technical edit. You may want to take a look through the document. It was written as if math was the only set of standards up for review. The second substantive issue I have is timing. and you heard my questions to Dr. Domenoski yesterday.

[02:17:19] Help me understand how we can do reviews in late May. Why do we wanna do these reviews in late May when we're not, he is recommending that we have the full operational assessments. The results of our tests are not gonna be done by then, but will be done a month later.

[02:17:39] So why are we, why May instead of June? And I'll raise a second timing issue, which as you know, we've traditionally done this standard setting process in the fall when we're asking teachers to volunteer to participate and asking superintendents to allow them to be part of this process.

[02:17:57] We are normally doing it when it's not quite such a high demand time for our teachers. And you need 100 plus teachers for this process to be taking teachers out of the classroom for both the training and the standard setting in April and May, right in the height of test season?

[02:18:22] Help me understand why that timeline makes sense. - Sure, so I think there's a couple important things. The first one is, along with other major initiatives we've released, including this one, we have heard time and time again from division superintendents and educators that they want more time to be able to understand anything that's new, to receive training and resources, and that being done prior to the school year.

[02:18:46] So this timeline allows us to produce those trainings and resources before the start of the school year so that divisions can use that in their PD days during the summer so that they're not being taken out of the classroom in the fall for training. So that's super important to our superintendents and our principals. So this timeline allows that to happen. It also allows divisions to receive preliminary data early in the fall and not have to wait to the winter to receive that data as they're learning all of these new components as well.

[02:19:15] I think another thing that's important to note is when we reviewed this process with our technical advisory committee and other national experts, they said similar things around making sure that there's a threshold of data that we meet before we use that data in the standard setting process, and we've confirmed that that would happen at the end of the testing window.

[02:19:38] We've also looked at prior year's history of when we have test completers, and the overwhelming majority of our divisions are completing their tests before that May timeline. So they have a larger window, but they're starting that more in the beginning. But am I not, sorry, thank you, is the plan to use this year's test data, but just the ones that have been completed before late May?

[02:20:03] No, as Dr. Domolesky stated yesterday, on multiple occasions when you asked him these questions yesterday. The intent is to do that training process and take that data. As I stated earlier, the TAC will be reviewing and helping us work through the process. There is nothing that says April or May. It says spring. We are working through the granular pieces of this with our TAC and with our national experts to make sure that we are following an evidence-based process, as Dr. Domolesky stated. At the same time, as M stated, we are trying to be responsive to the

[02:20:37] requests of educators. You heard our vast president say today, the more training, the more support, the more information we have earlier, the better off we are. So we are doing both things. We are making sure we're following an evidence-based process under the advisement of our TAC and making sure our school divisions and our educators have time to do that. We have worked with our educators to make sure that we have time for them when they are available to make sure this process happens that is part of our due diligence and that is why many things on here say spring june and july so that we can make sure we're responsive to the experts in the field and their support so

[02:21:17] uh miss holton uh yeah i so there was another document that said late may was when the standard setting was going to happen and that the training was going to happen before then and i'm not finding it and i apologize maybe that document's been withdrawn or maybe it's somewhere else but i uh i don't understand how and in particular some of our largest divisions i believe virginia beach and and fairfax represent 25 of the state don't complete testing until late because they're trying to help get in as much education as possible so can you help me understand what

[02:21:52] what impact data are we planning to use to do the ordered um the ordered item books the data from the spring 2025. so we are planning to use this spring's test administration not field test data and not partial data but this spring's test administration data dr canes that is what dr met domolesky said twice yesterday oh that's not what i heard from i didn't hear a company he repeated that after you said the other thing he said we are using this year's data okay well i'm sorry if i didn't hear that yesterday and i appreciate we're going to use the spring data so we're going to wait until the spring testing season is complete substantially

[02:22:28] complete we are going to work with our tac and under their advisement work through the granularity of the process as Dr. Domolesky stated yesterday. We are meeting with our TAC next week as we move through the granularity of the process. We will be bringing very detailed updates to the board every month to make sure that you are invested and aware and have opportunities to give feedback.

[02:22:54] As Ms. McPherson asked earlier in the committee process, the board will be intimately involved in each step. I appreciate that. And when we come back for this on final review, perhaps we can have a more confirmed timeline and you can help us understand how we're going to have this year's impact, this year's test data feed into the outcomes. Madam President, I have another question. Go ahead. Actually, this is discussion, if I may. Is it on this item? Yes. So I appreciate Dr. Kuhn's reminding all of us that this is a fundamental board responsibility, number one,

[02:23:34] and number two, we have not made any decisions yet about the process for this year, so that will be before us next month. There are some fundamental changes that are being recommended. Frankly, as Dr. Domolesky said, the change from ANGF to ID matching is maybe not that big a change, but this change where there's going to be a second round of consideration or an additional piece of information which is seeking to align our standards, our standard setting to the NAEP

[02:24:11] proficiency level, that is a board decision that the board has not yet made and it may well be the decision that this board is that the board may well be moving in that direction but and I you know I don't I don't I don't have a strong feeling on whether our which way we should go on that but Virginia has historically aligned our cut scores to closer to NAEP basic are they are our standards probably too low but when they're falling well below late NAEP basic as they have on some

[02:24:46] occasions? Probably yes. And so it makes sense to address them, I think. I concur with that spirit. Whether or not it makes sense to align them dramatically differently, 30 points, 40 points differently, all the way to NAEP proficient is a question that this board will have to wrestle with and own the consequences of. And the one thing I want it to be understood is that the proposal here is that we essentially decide ahead of time that our students are going to fail at a much

[02:25:24] higher rate. And then there's reasons to do that, but that we're deciding ahead of time that we're going to change, we're going to raise the height of the basketball hoop in hopes that that's going to help students shoot higher. And who knows? Maybe it will. There's certainly no evidence I've been shown, and Dr. Lemaleski was not able to give us any, and Dr. Northern and I had a conversation yesterday about what the research shows, and I won't repeat all that, but I don't think the evidence shows that changing cut scores, it may not do any harm, but it may not have much benefit.

[02:26:02] What really has benefit is what we do that helps students learn more and answer more questions correctly. You know, it's not how many, it's not where we draw the line, but what helps students get more answers right because they know more that really matters. And that's what I suggest our focus should be. But we are, the process we're being submitted is one that is going to define the outcome ahead of time before the students actually start taking the tests.

[02:26:35] We're going to define the outcomes that many, many, many more students are going to fail. And the one last thing I want to say, and that may be, and that's a choice that some Some states align with NAEP basic, and there's reasons to do that. Some states align with NAEP proficiency, and some line up in between, and there's arguments to be made for all of them.

[02:26:55] The one thing I would draw the Board's attention to and would ask the Department to help us think through, particularly in our March meeting, is if you're going to align to NAEP proficiency, because that is a dramatic change from our past practices, what other consequences, what other choices have we made as a board do we need to now go back and revisit so are there things in the accountability standards are there things in our graduation requirements are there other other rules we have put in place that are premised on where we have been more aligned to nate basic that

[02:27:31] we want to that we that this will have implications for and that we should at least know what we're doing and be ready to address those implications mr hansen and then miss uh then dr northern just a couple of comments the term consequences is thrown out like because if we align to the nape benchmarks that that's a bad thing i think it's a great thing because the evidence and all the data that we've seen for the last couple of months actually even the last couple years when mr

[02:28:07] schneider was up here and showed us the worst in the country since 2019 with the most significant and drop of our achievement scores, the consequences are dramatic if we don't do this.

[02:28:22] And I think the consequences of student learning, student success are more important than consequences of labeling or protecting systems or feelings or whatever it might be. And with all due

respect, when we talk about increasing the height of the basketball hoop, when we moved it down to eight feet, we're just trying to get it back up to 10 feet so we can actually have an opportunity to understand where we are so that we can again, as a board and as a commonwealth, address these challenges that our students and families and our school system are facing across the commonwealth

[02:29:00] to help bring improvement, to help target funding, help bring the reforms that we need to do to close the achievement gap, to stop the learning loss, and to get our system where it needs to be So it is providing the best educational opportunities for all of our students.

[02:29:19] - Dr. Northern. - I was just gonna mention Massachusetts, which is a pretty progressive state. And we saw yesterday that they were right there at NAEP Proficiency. And I work with Dave Driscoll, who was the Massachusetts commissioner for many years, who wrote a book about how they managed to do so well on NAEP.

[02:29:46] And he talks so convincingly about the importance of setting their cut scores to NAEP Proficient and really sees it. And again, it's not the silver bullet. We don't have those in education. But it was a critical piece to the supports and the other things that we're talking about that managed to get them where they are on NAEP.

[02:30:08] And he really had to fight a bunch of political battles because the pressures were very, very deep on not doing it. And they had to hold firm. And I would just submit that holding firm actually did produce very big benefits for the students of Massachusetts.

[02:30:34] Ms. McPherson. I think we all are in agreement as it relates to changing the cut scores to come into the compliance with NAEP as far as proficiency is concerned and to reach for that higher height.

[02:30:50] But I don't think that we in any way need to overlook the fact that we had chronic absenteeism. Some school systems are not supported as much as others. We've got an issue with a teacher shortage, we've got issues with special programs for the special education students, so I'm concerned that I want to make sure that we do have internally another group as part of the staff, which I know they are, but that we continue to get reports about the advances that we're making to correct some of these other problems so

[02:31:29] that the board will be able to analyze both what the change in the cut scores is doing as it relates to the other underlying issues because I'm particularly concerned about my region and all regions but my region I'm responsible for the demographics and how these other issues will impact the ability of those students to be able to perform once we change. Dr. Coons? Ms. McPherson I agree 100% so I want to just call out the attendance component we've been recognized nationally for the great work that our school divisions are using I actually want to call out one of your school divisions you heard dr armstrong talk about our models of attendance and

[02:32:09] our attendance workshops one of our models is in newport news they are doing some really great work around youth mental health first aid and they've been sharing through those attendance workshops what's working in newport news and how they're spreading that practice i think that's incredibly important one of the challenges we have in real-time data so if i could look at my colleague in rhode island she has a daily tracker on attendance and she has a data system that allows her to track that daily we get data submitted to us from school divisions in individual spreadsheets and then the data team has to clean that it takes about two months from the submission of data

[02:32:45] to us getting actually clean data but we will be committed to providing you updates on all of those things as quickly as my team is able but those are incredible aspects that we are tracking closely and Dr. Myers who you heard from earlier presented in the fall with AEI about our data around attendance and the incredible work that is happening in Virginia. So I'm really proud in particular about attendance but you mentioned some other things that I'm more than happy to work with you offline to make sure that we're reporting on.

[02:33:13] Appreciate that very much. Just want to keep us updated on how that impacts as we move forward with our testing. Madam President. Yes. Ms. Halton. I thank you all for those comments and I completely agree that what we need to focus on is what's going to actually help students do better in classrooms and and i think massachusetts is an excellent example and did make a choice to realign to nate proficiency and made choices to align other systems in massachusetts accordingly and in particular invested significant financial

[02:33:51] resources in their most underperforming schools and you know setting high bars is great but unless we're going to help our struggling schools, unless we're going to give them money, which is what it takes to incentivize the best teachers to be in teaching our neediest students and providing for things like extended school year and extended school day, which takes extra resources and extra tutoring. You know, there are some things that are lower cost. The high quality curriculum makes a

[02:34:28] difference. And we're moving along on that path, particularly in literacy. But unless we're making -- Massachusetts did exactly what we would need to do in Virginia if we make this change, and that is figure out how to align everything else, including resources.

[02:34:46] And we -- the General Assembly has, in its wisdom, pushed on resources, and in particular, this year's budget does push, including extra money for special ed kids. I hope the Governor signs agrees to that budget. It's still not where it needs to be. As we've seen in prior presentations, Virginia's neediest divisions do not get the 20 to 30 percent bump above the statewide average that they would need to produce the kind of results and that states like Massachusetts have invested. So money is part of it, but also we need to think about are there

[02:35:22] other adjustments to our, for instance, our accountability system decisions that we made last year, were premised on the cut scores being where they were before. If we bump up 30 or 40 percent, I guarantee you we're going to have 50 percent, maybe 70 percent of our schools are going to be labeled off track or needs intensive support. And then it's not a useful tool to identify the neediest schools to intervene in. If everybody is a failure, where do we where do we put our extra for resources, so that's just one example of many

[02:36:00] where if we make this dramatic shift, and there may well be, it's a communications tool, essentially, that's what we heard yesterday, and it may be a useful communications tool to get the public's attention. And if we choose to make that decision, then using it as a communications tool, but then making the other system adjustments to make it actually work, it's not a useful communications tool declare every school in this state a failure, then you don't know where to intervene.

[02:36:33] I look forward to seeing some data from you that shows that every school in the state is going to fail under the new system. If you take last year's SOL scores and move them up 40, if you move the cut scores up 40 percentage points, absolutely, and the department could give us that.

[02:36:53] In fact, that may be something we should ask them to do when we come back in March. If you were to align last year's data to NAEP cut scores, what would that do under the accountability system? I guarantee it would move, not 100%, but it would move way, way, way higher, way over 50% for sure.

[02:37:14] Well, we can come back with some non-arbitrary numbers and work towards that. Yeah, can we ask the department to do that next month? That would be very helpful. Discussion of current issues. I'm sorry, can I have a response to that question? That would be the department's responsibility for responding to that question.

[02:37:33] That's a part of... We direct the department to come back with that data in March. If they are prepared to do that, I don't know that they are because the data that we've received before took several months to do, so I cannot promise it in March. This would just be moving the cut scores. It's not redoing the data.

[02:37:49] Dr. Kuhns. The board had hired two consultants to do that work through the accountability process. those consultants are no longer on the same contract support. So I would have to go back and check and see if we have the capacity to even be able to do anything like that. So I can't respond today. Dr. Northern, I was just going to say that part of this really is about the misinformation. And we've talked about this before. The communication is that you're not as a parent, you're not receiving reliable information about how your child is doing. And I really do think as

[02:38:28] a parent, if you're told, you know, your kids doing fine on the SOL, and you've got an A in the class, that you are kind of proceeding blindly, that your child is going to just be fine. And so I don't see the communication issue as a as a bad thing. I think we're seeing all across the country, unfortunately, that parents do think their kids are doing fine because of the information that they're receiving. So unfortunately, we do need to give them better information, even if it's bad news.

[02:39:05] And I absolutely agree that we need to get the support system right, that we need to have the money to support the schools. All that is right. But, you know, we're doing the best we can to fix all these pieces of the puzzle because the ship, you know, we didn't see yesterday the slide that we probably needed to see, which was the lack of growth in Virginia from 2019 to the most recent NAEP administration. But that, to me, tells the story about what the dire situation that we're in, just in terms of these most recent years, and how much we've, you know,

[02:39:40] failed the kids, unfortunately. So all of that to say that I am just, I have no doubt that we're going to see more schools not doing well. That's true. And it's incumbent upon this board to get all these other pieces of the puzzle together. And we are trying so hard. I mean, what I see month after month after month of this board and the hard work that everybody's putting into this, it's just been a really honest attempt. And I'd rather us try our darndest to get all

[02:40:16] these pieces in place for kids, and maybe we don't get every piece right, you know, because it's, we're not going to get it all right. But I feel like we've got a good faith effort in trying to get it all pulled together and try to do the right thing. I feel like we're all well-intentioned folks, and often on the board, and when the folks see this online, it just seems like, you know, you know, it's like this. But I'll just say that I think we're all well-intentioned, and we're all trying to do the right thing and I just also want to get parents a better

[02:40:52] idea of how their child's really doing so they can take action on behalf of their child as well okay madam president can I just very briefly say I absolutely concur with dr. Norton that we all are looking to do what we think is right by children no doubt I have not questioned anybody's motives thank you okay we're moving on to the discussion of current issues you had something? Go ahead. Do you have a discussion of current issues or was that your

[02:41:27] discussion of current issues? Please proceed, Ms. Holton. Thank you. One is I did mention to Dr. Koons that we I think the board would really benefit from a legislative update. We've traditionally had a tool where we could get updated on legislation pending during the legislature and that we didn't get this season. But if we could get a legislative update at the March meeting, I think that would be very helpful. And the second thing is there was one item in the

[02:41:55] public comment about driver's ed. And this is just something I'd like to put on the table for a longer conversation. One way we are failing our students in terms of getting the skills that they need to be successful in life across all kinds of post-secondary options is we do not provide free, we do not consistently require our divisions to provide free driver's ed, including behind the wheel. And what a crucial skill set for getting all kinds of jobs. And we have a lot of kids who are neediest kids who are not succeeding in life in all kinds of ways

[02:42:31] and would be greatly benefited from getting a free not having to pay for the behind-the-wheel portion of driver's ed that their families can't pay for and so I can I just ask that we I don't have any idea whether the board has any authority to move that issue along I know there was some legislation you know encouraging etc but can I ask that we take a look to see if there's anything we can do to incentivize and or mandate our divisions to address driver said I don't need an immediate response but I'd just like to put that on the table when I think about the skill

[02:43:08] sets we're giving our kids when they graduate basic economics and personal finance which we are leaders on in Virginia is one but driving it would be a close second at all anybody else have items to discuss in discussion of current items or issues okay um you want to go first I just I you go ahead okay I guess as we end today I just want to acknowledge the recent sudden departure

[02:43:44] of Dr. Meg Bryce and extend my sincere gratitude to her and her service on our board her dedication to students and learners throughout the commonwealth has been as we all know the driving force behind her years of service to the commonwealth of Virginia and to its education system colleagues and students have benefited from her intelligence her perspective and her integrity, and she served the board and the Commonwealth with a true eye for what's best for children and families. I regret that politics got in the way of the service of a highly qualified

[02:44:19] board member and a dedicated public servant. It's a shame that some cannot separate the qualifications and achievements of Dr. Bryce herself from partisan, harmful games. This board and educators across the state work tirelessly to see and treat our students as individuals free from assumptions and associations that would suppress their potential and dim their light.

[02:44:47] We work because we know that our students deserve a seat at the table no matter where they come from. I'm sure my fellow board members will join me in commending Dr. Bryce for her dedication to these ideals and to students across Virginia. She has been a fighter for families and will continue to fight with for what's right and we regret that her time with us has been unfairly cut short but extend profound

gratitude to her for her service and her time that she spent with us. So Dr. Bryce your your mark on this board and the Commonwealth has been made and we thank you. And I think Dr.

[02:45:26] Coons do you have some comments? Yeah I just want to you've seen the team walk around manage the technology, move the tables, work through this, our security staff who is here to support us. I just want to commend the staff that puts these meetings together every month, that works hard to make sure that you have the receipts, that you have the lodging, that you have the food, that you have all the support there. But I also want to commend the staff that works behind the scenes. You heard Michelle Wallace talk about the educators that worked on the instructional textbook material process. There There are tons of people on our instructional team that have worked to produce instructional

[02:46:05] guides, resources, support textbook adoption processes, are in the field every day. You heard Dr. Armstrong talk about the attendance workshops, the things that the behavioral health and wellness team are doing. You heard Dr. Meyers come up and talk about the data work.

[02:46:24] There are tons of people in the agency and I just want to take a moment to thank the 532 employees that are working very hard to support the work of the children of the commonwealth to support the work of the board and continue to support our educators so i just wanted to take a moment to thank our teams that are behind the scenes every day at the agency madam president miss mcpherson i'd also like to thank the members of the public that show up to give their feedback on various issues i want them to know that while we take comments during the public

[02:47:01] comment period we're not in the position to respond to each of the comments during that time period because that's not the protocol but it's not to say that what you bring to us is not important we would encourage you to continue to come so that we can keep our eyes and our ears open on the issues that the community believes faces them and impacts them on the individual as well as on a community level and i want you to be assured that the board is doing everything we can to look at those issues. We're asking our staff to revisit them. We're asking the Attorney General's office to weigh in as necessary, and we continue to get updated reports. So again, I just want to thank

[02:47:40] the members of the public because we do in fact serve you. Thank you. If there's nothing else, then I will entertain a motion to adjourn. Moved. Is there a second? All those in favor of adjourning? And we are adjourned.

